

Part A:

↑ Share ...

Trying to figure out for an assignment, how to return the value of 1, which would be the path cost.

This is for introduction to Artificial Intelligence, as you know.

All valid moves are stored in an array/list called `legal_actions`, derived from `MOVES`, with is a key-value pair that uses `UP`, `DOWN`, `LEFT` and `RIGHT` as keys

📄 ✎

Thought for a couple of seconds >

Yes, in this kind of AI search assignment, the **path cost** is often just the cost of taking one action.

So if every valid move has the same cost, your function should return:

Python

```
return 1
```

📄 ▶ Run

The important idea is:

Python

```
legal_actions
```

📄 ▶ Run

only tells you which moves are allowed from the current state.

The **path cost** tells the search algorithm ↓ how expensive it is to take one of those moves.

The important idea is:

```
</> Python
legal_actions
```

[Run](#)

only tells you **which moves are allowed** from the current state.

The **path cost** tells the search algorithm **how expensive it is to take one of those moves**.

So even if your moves come from something like:

```
</> Python
MOVES = {
    "UP": (-1, 0),
    "DOWN": (1, 0),
    "LEFT": (0, -1),
    "RIGHT": (0, 1)
}
```

[Run](#)

and your valid moves are stored in:

```
</> Python
legal_actions = ["UP", "RIGHT"]
```

[Run](#)

the cost of choosing "UP" or "RIGHT" can still just be 1.

A simple version could look like this:

```
</> Python
def path_cost(action):
    return 1
```

[Run](#)

I am working on an Introduction to AI search assignment.

Please help me debug my path cost / legal actions / result function logic step by step.

Do not edit my files or automatically fix the code. I only want an explanation and guidance.

When you find the issue:

- Explain what the function is supposed to do.
- Explain what my current code is doing instead.
- Show the minimal code change I should make manually.
- Explain why the change works.
- Do not use tools to modify files.

Now I have a traceback that says GridProblem object has no attribute depth under cell 37

Show less ^

Jun 10, 4:47 AM 

Worked for 26s >

The error is in your recursive DLS call, not in `GridProblem.path_cost`, `actions`, or `result`.

Worked for 26s >

The error is in your recursive DLS call,
not in `GridProblem`, `path_cost`,
`actions`, or `result`.

What the function expects

python



```
def _recursive_dls(self, problem
```

- `problem` should be a `GridProblem`.
- `node` should be a `Node`, which has `.depth`.

What your code does

python



```
result, status = self._recursive
```

The first two arguments are reversed.
Therefore:

- `problem` receives `child`
- `node` receives the `GridProblem`

Then this line fails:

python



```
node.depth
```

because `node` is actually the
`GridProblem`.



Animal change

This says the problem was not defined here. But is problem a parameter for this?

Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 14:9-10

Optimized tool selection

Analyzed GridProblem class and its actions method

No, `problem` is not a parameter here. The parameter is `state` (a tuple like `(row, col)`).

Looking at the incomplete code in the `actions` method, I see several issues:

```
def actions(self, state: Tuple[int, int]):
    legal_actions = []
    dr, dc = MOVES[state] # ❌ ERROR
    n_row, n_col = self.row + dr, self.col + dc
```

The problems are:

1. `MOVES[state]` — You can't look up a state (like `(0,0)`) in `MOVES`. `MOVES` keys are action names like `"UP"`, `"DOWN"`, etc.
2. `self.row` — Should be unpacking the state first: `row, col = state`
3. **Missing loop** — You need to loop through each action in `MOVES`, not try to index state directly.

Restores workspace and chat to this point

My implementation is correct, I got a bit confused

Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 26:6-34

Optimized tool selection

Analyzed BFS implementation issues in search method

Let me look at your BFS code more closely. I can see several issues:

Reviewed Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb lines 714 to 777

Here are the main problems I see:

1. `return "failure"` is inside the while loop — It returns after expanding just the first node instead of continuing until the frontier is empty
2. `max_frontier_size = 0` at the start of each iteration — This resets it every time instead of tracking the maximum across all iterations
3. Returns plain strings instead of `SearchResult` objects — The function should return a `SearchResult`, not `"success"` or `"failure"`
4. `reached` should be a set, not a list — Better performance for membership checks
5. There's also a bug in the `expand` method — It calls `node(...)` instead of `Node(...)` (missing capital N)

How are search result objects returned?

Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 0:12-40

Analyzed SearchResult object structure
and BFS implementation issues

`SearchResult` is a dataclass that needs to be instantiated with specific parameters. Looking at the definition:

```
@dataclass
class SearchResult:
    algorithm: str
    status: str
    solution: Optional[Node]
    nodes_expanded: int
    max_frontier_size: int
    reached_count: int = 0
    limit: Optional[int] = None
    iterations: Optional[List[Dict
```

You need to return it like this:

```
return SearchResult(
    algorithm="BFS",
    status="success",
    solution=child_node,
    nodes_expanded=42,
    max_frontier_size=15,
```

× Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 35

Ask a question about your code or project

I'm I on the right track so far?

Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 32:61-94

Reviewed implementation of
`\_recursive\_dls` method

Looking at your `_recursive_dls`
implementation, I can see a few issues that
need correcting:

Issues to Fix:

1. **Return type mismatch:** The method signature says it returns `Tuple[Optional[Node], str]` (a node and a status string), but you're returning `SearchResult` objects. It should return tuples like `(node, "success")` or `(None, "cutoff")`.
2. **Path-cycle checking:** You're checking `if child.state == node.state` to skip the child, but you should use the provided `state_is_on_path()` helper function instead. This checks if the child state appears anywhere on the entire path from root to current node, not just the immediate parent:

```
if state_is_on_path(node, child.state):  
    continue
```

3. **Stack size tracking:** The line `len(current_stack_size)` won't work because `current_stack_size` is an integer (1), not a list. Since this is a recursive implementation, you should track depth or pass the recursion depth as a parameter to monitor the call stack.

× Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 35

Ask a question about your code or project

← PROGRESS EVALUATION

Restore Checkpoint · 🗑️

for the stack size tracking, could I track depth everytime recursive_dls is recursively called? So the depth is tied to node.depth?

📄 Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb · Cell 32:63-89

Considered using `node.depth` for tracking recursion depth

Yes, that's a **much cleaner approach!** Since `node.depth` is automatically managed by the `Node` class and directly corresponds to the recursion depth, you can absolutely use it for stack size tracking.

Here's the idea:

```
def _recursive_dls(
    self,
    problem: Problem,
    node: Node,
    limit: int,
    metrics: Dict[str, int],
) -> Tuple[Optional[Node], str]:

    # Track recursion depth as provided
    metrics["max_stack_size"] = max(metrics["max_stack_size"], node.depth)

    if problem.is_goal(node.state):
        return (node, "success")

    elif node.depth >= limit:
        return (None, "cutoff")

    else:
        metrics["nodes_expanded"] += 1
        cutoff_occurred = False

        for child in self.expand(problem, node):
            if state_is_on_path(not cutoff_occurred):
                continue
```

← PROGRESS EVALUATION



This works because each recursive call lands at a deeper depth, and `node.depth` automatically tracks that for you.

So given the `node.depth + 1`. Could you say `dls` is recursively called, the node that gets passed will automatically have a new depth per each recurse. So it means you'd increase the size to add on to the last depth?

Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb • Cell 10

Analyzed tracking recursion depth using `node.depth + 1`

Exactly right! You've got the key insight.

Here's why it works:

- **Initial call:** `node.depth = 0` → recursion depth = 1 → record `0 + 1 = 1` ✓
- **First recursive call:** `node.depth = 1` → recursion depth = 2 → record `1 + 1 = 2` ✓
- **Second recursive call:** `node.depth = 2` → recursion depth = 3 → record `2 + 1 = 3` ✓

Since `Node.__post_init__` automatically increments depth for each child, `node.depth` perfectly mirrors the recursion depth.

And yes—you update the `max` whenever you see a deeper level:



Restore Checkpoint · 🗑️

I get bug 2 and bug 3 but not bug 1, If a node is being expanded, is the parent reference to the node that gets passed before the new node gets the yield?

Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb · Cell 32:49-76

Considered parent reference for expanded node children

Good question! Let me clarify bug 1:

When you **expand** a node, you're creating its **children**. Each child's parent should point to **the node being expanded** (the one passed as parameter), not to that node's parent.

Think of it this way:

```
grandparent
  |
  parent_node (this is what is passed)
 /  |  \
c1  c2  c3 (these children are created)
```

When you call `expand(parent_node)`, the children c1, c2, c3 should have:

- `parent = parent_node` ✓ (the node being expanded)
- `parent = parent_node.parent` ✗ (would skip a generation!)

← **PROGRESS EVALUATION** 
you're expanding, not an ancestor of that
node. Does that make sense?

Restore Checkpoint · 

Ah I see, expand takes node, so the
expanded should reference the node
that got passed into the expand
method?

 Lab_1_Part_A.ipynb · Cell 32:49-76

Clarified parent reference for expand
method usage

Exactly right! ✓

When you call `expand(node)`, the `node`
parameter is the one being expanded, so its
children should have `parent=node`.

Currently you have:

```
parent = node.parent # ❌ Wrong -
```

Change it to:

```
parent = node # ✓ The node being e
```

Then the yield becomes:

```
   ...  
yield Node(s_prime, parent=node, act
```

This way the parent chain is correct: each
child points directly to the node that
generated it.

I am testing out the search algos with a custom map, if you look at cell 40.

I have done the grid, but I need help on defining what the goal would be

Worked for 23s >

Use a free cell represented as a `(row, column)` tuple. A good test is to place the start and goal at opposite ends of your connected route:

python



```
custom_start_1 = (1, 1)
custom_goal_1 = (17, 17)
```

Why `(17, 17)` works:

python



```
custom_grid_1[12:18, 12:18] = 0
```

Python slices exclude the endpoint, so this creates free cells from rows and columns `12` through `17`. Thus `(17, 17)` is free and reachable through your corridors.

Do not use:

python



Part B

What does this line mean in the comments?

```
#  
reached[s] = child
```

Does it mean that the current state from `reached` is now placed into the node `child` receives from `expand`?

That line means:

```
python  
reached[s] = child
```

stores the **child node** in the `reached` dictionary, using the child's state `s` as the key.

So if:

```
python  
s = child.state
```

then:

```
python  
reached[s] = child
```

means:



"Record that we have reached state

Quick question, do I have to return a `SearchResult` object for all the algorithms? Just like the Best first search one?

Yes. In this notebook design, every algorithm's `search(...)` method should return a `SearchResult` object.

That keeps the rest of the notebook consistent, especially helper functions like:

```
python
show_results(results)
result_to_row(result)
plot_path(..., path=result.path
```

So even if the algorithm finds a `Node`, it should wrap it:

```
python
return SearchResult(
    algorithm=algorithm,
    status="success",
    solution=node,
    nodes_expanded=nodes_expand
    max_frontier_size=max_front
    reached_count=len(reached),
)
```

And for failure:

Wait, the priority queue, which in this case a min heap, has the node with the lowest heuristic at the top?

Yes.

In this notebook, `PriorityQueue` is a **min-heap**, so the item with the **lowest priority value** is popped first.

For **Greedy Best-First Search**, the priority is:

```
python
f(n) = h(n)
```

So the node with the **lowest heuristic estimate** is at the front of the search.

Meaning:

Greedy expands the node that appears closest to the goal according to the heuristic.

Example:

```
python
frontier.push(5, node_a)
frontier.push(2, node_b)
frontier.push(8, node_c)
```

Then:



```
python
```


What would the method signature for the f-limited search be?

A good method signature would be:

```
python

def _f_limited_search(
    self,
    node: Node,
    problem: Problem,
    limit: float,
    metrics: Dict[str, int],
) -> Tuple[Optional[Node], float]
```

Meaning:

- `node` : the current search node
- `problem` : the grid problem
- `limit` : the current f-cost limit
- `metrics` : dictionary for tracking `nodes_expanded` and max recursion depth/stack size

It returns:

```
python

(result, new_f)
```

Where:

- `result` is a `Node` if the goal was found, otherwise `None`
- `new_f` is either the evaluation f

For the metrics, don't I need to update the `max_frontier_size`, to track depth?

Yes. For IDA*, `max_frontier_size` is being used to approximate the maximum recursion stack depth, not a real frontier size.

Since IDA* is recursive depth-first search, you can update it using the node depth:

```
python
metrics["max_frontier_size"] =
    metrics["max_frontier_size"]
    node.depth + 1,
)
```

Use `node.depth + 1` because the root has `depth == 0`, but the stack contains one node at the root.

Put that near the start of `_f_limited_search`, before returning for cutoff or goal:

```
python
metrics["max_frontier_size"] =
    metrics["max_frontier_size"]
    node.depth + 1,
)
↓
f = node.path_cost + self.heuri
```


The thing is that metrics has not been defined at all, does it mean I have to create the metrics dict, then pass it to f limited search? Or I make it an optional parameter? but step 3 requires you to track both nodes expanded and the max frontier size

Yes, create the `metrics` dictionary inside `search()`, then pass it into `_f_limited_search()`.

Do not make it optional here. Since the requirement says to track `nodes_expanded` and `max_frontier_size`, make it explicit.

Inside `search()`:

```
python
metrics = {
    "nodes_expanded": 0,
    "max_frontier_size": 1,
}
```

Then pass it into each IDA* iteration:

```
python
result, next_limit = self._f_li
    initial_node,
    problem,
    limit,
    metrics,
```

I have to design two additional maps now. I will use numpy just like how I used it for part A

That is fine. For Part B, at least one of the two should be a `WeightedGridProblem` with meaningful terrain costs.

A good setup is:

Map 1: heuristic trap

Use obstacles to create a U-shape where the goal is visually close, but the opening is away from the goal. This tests Greedy.

Map 2: cheap long route vs expensive short route

Use terrain costs so the direct path is short but expensive, while a longer detour is cheaper. This tests UCS/A* against Greedy/Weighted A*.

With NumPy, the pattern is:

```
python
custom_grid_1 = np.zeros((15, 15))
custom_costs_1 = np.ones((15, 15))
```

Then add obstacles:

```
python
custom_grid_1[3:12, 7] = 1
```

And terrain costs:

Need a check from the top, apart from the reflection questions. I want to be sure that's the only thing left

Worked for 49s >

Not quite only reflections. I'd fix/check these before calling it done:

1. `BestFirstSearch.nodes_expanded` is being counted in the wrong place. Right now it increments inside the child loop, so it counts generated children, not expanded nodes. Move it to just before the `for child in self.expand(...)` loop:

```
python
nodes_expanded += 1

for child in self.expand(problem.state):
    state = child.state
    ...
```

and remove the current `nodes_expanded += 1` inside that loop. Then rerun all result tables because node counts will change.

2. IDA* needs a cutoff return after the `for range(max_iterations)` loop. If max iterations are exhausted, your `search()` currently falls through and returns `No`. Add: